

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments and collections product specialist.*

Positioning, Ten years building scalable, automated financial workflows across regulated B2B environments – ready to own Riverty's Installments & Payments product end-to-end.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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§ WHY RIVERTY

Riverty is solving a genuinely hard UX problem: making debt repayment feel fair and navigable rather than punitive, at scale across 11 countries and dozens of regulatory regimes. The posting's emphasis on self-service journeys, AI-assisted decision logic, and reducing manual process steps maps directly to the infrastructure and automation work I have shipped in production. What draws me in particular is the Human Centric Collection framing – designing payment agreements around the debtor's situation rather than around internal operational convenience is a product philosophy worth building for. *That is precisely the kind of constraint that sharpens product thinking rather than blunting it.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked inside a debt-collection or receivables-management operation specifically. My payments experience comes from designing a P2P payment product from scratch at Kvitt, owning PSP integration and consumer payment UX, and working in adjacent regulated environments including InsurTech, public-sector data platforms, and a government defence programme. The transferable mechanic I bring is translating complex, rule-laden operational processes into automated, auditable software – which is exactly what Installments & Payments requires.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting, edge-case generation, discovery synthesis
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo acceleration and spec validation
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted development environments
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for concept validation
 - **Framer**, design-heavy interface work and stakeholder demos
 - **n8n**, multi-agent and workflow automation orchestration
 - **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder communication and roadmap decks
 - **GPT**, research synthesis and document drafting
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, GitOps, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, AngularJS, Ionic, Docker, Bitbucket, Git.

§ SIDE PROJECT

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A group-based P2P payment product built from zero, later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.

- Designed and shipped the full P2P payment flow including group settlement logic, PSP integration, and edge-case handling for split, partial, and disputed payments.
- Architected on a P2P backbone with native mobile prototype on iOS and Android; full UX and UI design ownership.
- Operated the product for five years before acquisition, giving long-cycle feedback on real payment behaviour in production.
- Direct precedent for Riverty's self-service payment journey work: same core challenge of making a financial interaction feel simple when the underlying state machine is not.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT RIVERTY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with Operations and the existing product team to map the current Installments & Payments journey end-to-end – identifying where manual steps survive, where KPIs are already tracked and where they are not, and where the biggest drop-offs in self-service adoption occur.

WEEK 2

Slice and validate.

Take the two or three highest-friction points surfaced in week one, frame them as testable hypotheses, and align with Tech and Data on what instrumentation exists to validate them quickly versus what needs to be built first.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Begin driving the first prioritised backlog items into sprint with clear acceptance criteria, measurable outcomes, and stakeholder sign-off – establishing the cadence and documentation standards that let downstream teams configure and extend payment logic without coming back to me for every edge case.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Riverty team,

Payment products sit at the intersection of operational complexity and consumer trust – and getting that intersection right is the work I find most interesting. Riverty's Installments & Payments role is asking for exactly the kind of product ownership I have been doing across regulated environments for nearly a decade: translating layered business rules and regulatory requirements into self-service flows that actually work for the people on the other end of them.

My most directly relevant precedent is Kvitt Payment Solutions, which I co-founded and built from zero: a group-based P2P payment product covering settlement logic, PSP integration, edge-case handling, and a full mobile prototype. I owned everything from the initial UX design to the technical integration to the eventual handover when Sparkasse acquired and operated the product. That experience gave me a concrete, long-cycle view of what breaks in payment flows

under real conditions – partial payments, disputed splits, failed retries, user abandonment at confirmation screens – the same failure modes that a collection-context payment product needs to handle gracefully.

More recently at Rohde & Schwarz, I delivered an automated data transformation and audit platform inside the FCAS programme – a government contract with multinational stakeholders, strict data lineage requirements, and no tolerance for opaque decisions. I reduced deployment times from multiple days to under 40 minutes through GitOps, unblocked infrastructure issues the senior engineering team had queued for over a year, and delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end from user story to production rollout. The discipline required there – treating auditability and reproducibility as product requirements, not afterthoughts – transfers directly to regulated payment and collection products where every decision about a consumer's repayment terms needs to be traceable.

At Emil Group's InsurTech platform I re-established delivery stability in a prototype-stage environment that had lost client trust. I restructured a 17-person team into smaller scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops to rebuild transparency with clients. That experience is relevant to Riverty's stated goal of enabling teams to configure and apply payment logic independently – the harder problem is not designing the logic, it is building the documentation, training, and review structures that make it usable without the product manager in the room.

I work natively with AI tools in my product process – Claude and GPT for requirements and edge-case synthesis, n8n for workflow automation prototyping, Lovable for rapid front-end concept validation – and I bring five years of practical Python experience that lets me read and challenge data and automation proposals rather than depend on engineers to interpret them. I am based in Berlin, authorised to work in Germany without restriction, and available on four weeks' notice.

I would welcome the chance to talk through what the Installments & Payments roadmap looks like today and where you see the biggest leverage points over the next 12 months.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational and regulatory requirements into scalable, automated software. Background spans payment

product design, regulated B2B SaaS, government data platforms, and AI systems – with consistent delivery ownership from discovery through production rollout. Comfortable operating in ambiguity, aligning cross-functional stakeholders without formal authority, and building the documentation and process structures that let teams move independently. Fluent in AI-native workflows and technically literate across the full modern software stack.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Translating complex operational and regulatory requirements into scalable product solutions
 - Payment flow design, PSP integration, and consumer payment UX
 - AI-assisted product execution and workflow automation
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment without formal authority
 - Backlog management, sprint discipline, and delivery velocity tracking
 - KPI-oriented discovery, prioritisation, and product instrumentation
 - Data platform and ETL pipeline product ownership
 - Audit trails, data provenance, and compliance-aware product design
 - Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, full ownership
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Reduced deployment times from multiple days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and full data provenance audit trails
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature queued from the engineering team for over a year
- Led cross-functional team: architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, QA, multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin features on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, reducing manual data pipeline overhead
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Designed interactive dashboards and community features for regional stakeholders

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation for a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance time-to-market from one year to under one week
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline by restructuring a 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units with ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement lost under delivery pressure; reduced senior developer attrition to a single departure
- Regained client trust through structured communication and weekly product workshops in a prototype-stage environment

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on a mobile-first hospital app
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external databases

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Co-Founder & Product Lead

- Designed and built a group-based P2P payment product from zero: settlement logic, PSP integration, full UX and UI design, mobile app prototype on iOS and Android
- Operated the product for five years across real consumer payment conditions before acquisition and operation by Sparkasse
- Built deep practical knowledge of payment edge cases: partial settlements, failed retries, disputed splits, user abandonment at confirmation

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Served as deputy IT security officer; designed product for setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required

COVID-19 DATA PLATFORM, BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

Product Owner

- Delivered RKI projects DIM and DESH: secure data structures and identity management for national pandemic data infrastructure

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policy workflows

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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